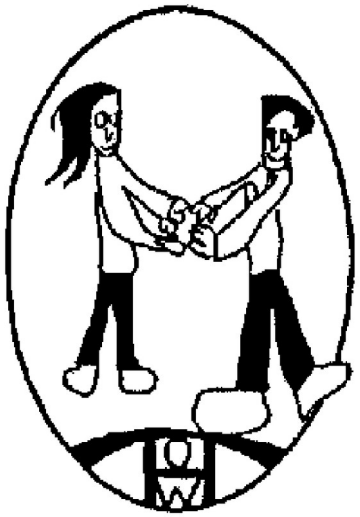
Howbridge Infant School



Educational Visits Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body:
January 2026

Howbridge Infant School - Educational Visits Policy

January 2026

Our school core values:

We are kind.
We are respectful.
We are curious.

Context

We believe that educational visits are an integral part of the entitlement of every pupil to an effective and balanced curriculum. Appropriately planned visits are known to enhance learning and improve attainment, and so form a key part of what makes Howbridge Infant School a supportive and effective learning environment. The benefits to pupils of taking part in visits and learning outside the classroom include, but are not limited to:

- Improvements in their ability to cope with change.
- Increased critical curiosity and resilience.
- Opportunities for meaning making, creativity, developing learning relationships and practising strategic awareness.
- Increased levels of trust and opportunities to examine the concept of trust (us in them, them in us, them in themselves, them in each other).
- Improved achievement and attainment across a range of curricular subjects. Pupils are active participants not passive consumers, and a wide range of learning styles can flourish.
- Enhanced opportunities for 'real world' 'learning in context' and the development of the social and emotional aspects of intelligence.
- Increased risk management skills through opportunities for involvement in practical risk-benefit decisions in a range of contexts. ie. encouraging pupils to become more risk aware as opposed to risk averse.
- Greater sense of personal responsibility.
- Possibilities for genuine team working including enhanced communication skills.
- Improved environmental appreciation, knowledge, awareness and understanding of a variety of environments.
- Improved awareness and knowledge of the importance and practices of sustainability.
- Physical skill acquisition and the development of a fit and healthy lifestyle.

Application

Any visit that leaves the school grounds is covered by this policy, whether as part of the curriculum, during school time, or outside the normal school day.

In addition to this Educational Visits Policy, Howbridge Infant School:

1. Adopts the Local Authority's (LA) document: **'Guidance for Educational Visits and Related Activities with National Guidance & EVOLVE'** (All staff have access to this via EVOLVE).
2. Adopts National Guidance www.oeapng.info, (as recommended by the LA).

3. Uses EVOLVE, the web-based planning, notification, approval, monitoring and communication system for off-site activities.

All staff are required to plan and execute visits in line with school policy (ie this document), Local Authority policy, and National Guidelines. Staff are particularly directed to be familiar with the roles and responsibilities outlined within the guidance.

Types of visit

There are three types of visit:

1. Routine local visits in the 'Extended learning locality' (See Appendix 1).
2. Day visits within the UK that do not involve an adventurous activity.
3. Visits that are either overseas, residential, and/or involve an adventurous activity – These are not applicable to our school.

Roles and responsibilities

Visit leaders are responsible for the planning of their visits, and for entering these on EVOLVE (where required). They should obtain outline permission for a visit from the Head Teacher or EVC prior to planning, and certainly before making any commitments. Visit leaders have responsibility for ensuring that their visits will comply with all relevant guidance and requirements.

The Educational Visits Coordinator (EVC) are Kate Coyne and Eleanor Ward, who will support and challenge colleagues over visits and learning outside the classroom (LOtC) activities. The EVC is the first point of contact for advice on visit related matters, and will check final visit plans on EVOLVE before submitting them to the Head. The EVC sets up and manages the staff accounts on EVOLVE, and uploads generic school documents, etc.

The Head Teacher has responsibility for authorising all visits and for submitting all overseas, residential or adventurous activity visits to the LA for approval, via EVOLVE.

The Governing Body's role is that of a 'critical friend'. Individual governors may request 'read-only' access to EVOLVE.

The Local Authority is responsible for the final approval (via EVOLVE) of all visits that are either overseas, residential, and/or involve an adventurous activity.

Staff Competence

We recognise that staff competence is the single most important factor in the safe management of visits, and so we support staff in developing their competence in the following ways:

- An apprenticeship system, where staff new to visits assist and work alongside experienced visit leaders before taking on a leadership role.
- Supervision by senior staff on some educational visits.
- Support for staff to attend training courses relevant to their role, where necessary.

In deciding whether a member of staff is competent to be a visit leader, the Head Teacher will take into account the following factors:

- Relevant experience.

- Previous relevant training.
- The prospective leader's ability to make dynamic risk management judgements, and take charge in the event of an emergency.
- Knowledge of the pupils, the venue, and the activities to be undertaken.

Approval

The approval process is as follows for each type of visit:

1. Local visits follow the 'Extending learning locality' policy (Appendix 1). Day visits within the UK that do not involve an adventurous activity. These are entered on EVOLVE, and must be submitted to the EVC for checking at least 14 days in advance, and then forwarded to the Head for approval.
2. Visits that are overseas, residential, and/or involve an adventurous activity (see LA guidance for definition of 'adventurous') are then submitted by the Head to the LA for approval.

Emergency procedures

A critical incident is any incident where events go beyond the normal coping mechanisms and experience of the visit leadership team.

The school has an emergency plan in place to deal with a critical incident during a visit (see Appendix 2). All staff on visits are familiar with this plan and it is tested at least bi-annually and following any major staffing changes.

When an incident overwhelms the establishment's emergency response capability, or where it involves serious injury or fatality, or where it is likely to attract media attention then assistance will be sought from the local authority.

Educational Visits Checklist

Howbridge Infant School Educational Visits Checklist forms part of the risk management process for visits and off-site activities. This has been adapted from the LA's generic checklist. A visit should only go ahead if the answer to all relevant questions is 'YES'. Howbridge Infant Schools Educational Visits Checklist is attached at the end of this policy and available on Google Drive in the Educational Visits folder (Part of curriculum folder on shared drive).

Parental Consent

The school obtains blanket consent at the start of each year for activities that fall within the 'Extended learning locality' (see Appendix 1). Parents have the option of consenting online via EVOLVE, or through a traditional paper consent form.

Specific, (ie. one-off), parental consent must be obtained for all other visits. For these visits, sufficient information must be made available to parents (via EVOLVE, letters, meetings, etc), so that consent is given on a 'fully informed' basis. As above, parents have the option of consenting online via EVOLVE or through a traditional paper consent form.

Inclusion

Please refer to our school Inclusion Policy.

Charging / funding for visits

The school will seek voluntary contributions from parents/carers where applicable.

The school will not exclude a child from participating in an activity during the school day on financial grounds.

Where 10% or more of parents decline to make the requested voluntary contribution, (their identity will remain confidential and they will not be discriminated against), it will be at the Headteacher's discretion whether the visit will take place.

No charge applies for activities taking place during school hours except any of those listed below

- for transport during school hours for school-organised activities except for educational visits
- for activities outside school hours that are part of the set curriculum including sports matches against other schools / academies

Transport

3 quotes for transport are gathered before transport is booked. Transport is booked from a list of approved companies.

We also use the community bus from the local district council for visits involving small numbers of children participating e.g. sports events.

Insurance

Insurer AIG Europe Limited via Risk Management Partners
Policy Number 0010626148
Policy Period 1st April 2025 to 31st March 2026, both dates inclusive

Insured Persons :

Category A – Any Pupil enrolled at a participating establishment

Category B – Any Employee of a participating establishment

Category C – Any Adult who is acting in a supervisory capacity as a Volunteer, Assistant or Helper and is authorised by a participating establishment

Category D – Any Child other than as described in Category A that is authorised by a participating establishment to undertake a trip

Appendix 1 - Extended Learning Locality (Local Area Visit)

Boundaries

The boundaries of the locality will be decided on a visit by visit basis and will be agreed with the Head Teacher & EVCs. This area includes the following frequently used venues: *e.g.*

- *shop*
- *library*
- *park*
- *river walk*
- *post box*
- *local walking visit .*

We use this extended area on a regular basis for a variety of learning activities, and approved staff are allowed to operate in this area without completing the EVOLVE visit approval process, provided they follow the below Operating Procedure.

Operating Procedure for Extended Learning Locality

The following are potentially significant issues/hazards within our extended locality:

- Road traffic.
- Other people / members of the public / animals.
- Losing a pupil.
- Uneven surfaces and slips, trips, and falls.
- Weather conditions.
- Activity specific issues when doing environmental fieldwork (nettles, brambles, rubbish, etc).
- Water – River Walk

These are managed by a combination of the following:

- The **Head, Deputy or EVC** must give verbal approval before a group leaves.
- Only staff judged competent to supervise groups in this environment are approved. A current list of approved staff is maintained by the EVC and office.
- The concept and Operating Procedure of the ‘Extended learning locality’ is explained to all new parents when their child joins the school.
- There will normally be a minimum of two adults. EYFS 1:4, KS1 1:6

- Staff are familiar with the area, including any ‘no go areas’, and have practised appropriate management techniques.
- Pupils have been trained and have practised standard techniques for road crossings in a group.
- Where appropriate, pupils are fully briefed on what to do if they become separated from the group.
- All remotely supervised work in the extended learning locality is done in ‘buddy’ pairs as a minimum.
- Pupils’ clothing and footwear is checked for appropriateness prior to leaving school.
- Staff are aware of any relevant pupil medical information and ensure that any required medication is available.
- Staff will deposit in the office a list of all pupils and staff, a proposed route, and an estimated time of return.
- A school mobile is taken with each group and the office have a note of the number.
- Appropriate personal protective equipment is taken when needed

Appendix 2 – Emergency Procedure

The school’s emergency response to an incident is based on the following key factors:

1. There is always a nominated emergency base contact for any visit (during school hours this is the office).
2. This nominated base contact will either be an experienced member of the senior management team, or will be able to contact an experienced senior manager at all times.
3. For activities that take place during normal school hours, the visit leadership team will be aware of any relevant medical information for all participants, including staff.
4. For activities that take place outside normal school hours, the visit leadership team and the emergency contact/s will be aware of any relevant medical information and emergency contact information for all participants, including staff.
5. The visit leader/s and the base contact/s know to request support from the local authority in the event that an incident overwhelms the establishment’s emergency response capability, involves serious injury or fatality, or where it is likely to attract media attention.
6. For visits that take place outside the ‘extended learning locality’, the visit leader will carry either:
   a) An LA Emergency ‘Card’ (see EVOLVE Resources), or
   b) An OEAP National Guidance Emergency action card *(Available via www.oeap.info)*
7. This Emergency Procedure is tested through both desktop exercises and periodic scenario calls from visit leaders.

6. For visits that take place outside the ‘extended learning locality’, the visit leader will carry an LA Emergency ‘Card’ (see EVOLVE Resources).

Visit Leader Planning Checklist

<table>
<tr><td>Date of Trip:
Times:</td><td>Visit Leader Completed</td><td>EVC</td></tr>
<tr><td>Venue:
Do they hold LOtC badge? yes/no
If not please complete provider form.</td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Coaches booked: Coach company?

<table><tr><td>Coach 1 Number of Seats:
Coach 2 Number of Seats:</td></tr><tr><td>Double Decker yes/no -</td></tr></table></td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Staff Support

<table><tr><td>Class 7</td><td>Class 8</td><td>Class 9</td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td>3</td><td>3</td></tr></table>If a class is to be split please indicate

Adults specified on itinerary</td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Parent Helpers

See itinerary</td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Self Disclosure forms completed for all volunteers & checked by Head Teacher</td><td></td><td></td></tr>
</table>

Volunteer emergency contact forms completed		
Parent helper meeting held before trip		
Parent helper information sheets handed out		
Trip logged on evolve and all necessary risk assessments carried out including care plans and medical forms		
EVC to approve trip		
Each class teacher to have a copy of the full risk assessment		
Full risk assessment left with office		
Red Bags checked and ready		
All children to wear red bands		
Children's emergency contact forms to be taken		
All medication to be taken and kept with the class teacher or TA		
First Aid Kit for each group including ice pack		
Sick bowl and spare clothes for each class		
Lunches ordered via the office	Completed	
	Completed	
Signed Visit Leader	**Date**	
Signed EVC	**Date**	

Visit final numbers to be completed on the morning of the trip

Class 1	**Class 2**	**Class 3**	**Total**
Children: **Staff:** **Volunteers:**	**Children:** **Staff:** **Volunteers:**	**Children:** **Staff:** **Volunteers:**	**Children:** **Staff:** **Volunteers:**

Coach 1 - Adult	**Coach 2 - Adult**